



YOU ARE **20 WEEKS EXACTLY** 140 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Although your baby may be sucking their thumb, this is a very complex action that is not fully developed at this stage. For this reason, your baby is as likely to put their fingers or toes in their mouth as their thumb.

“Congratulations—you’re now halfway through your pregnancy. In around 20 weeks’ time, you’ll be a mom.”

Does it seem like a lifetime, or has it flown by? At least from now on, you really will be counting down.

The gestation period for an elephant is 22 months, the longest of any land animal. In addition, the common birth weight for elephants is 265lb (120kg). So, if your pregnancy is already starting to feel long, and your baby a tad heavy, spare a thought for our large-eared friends!

Hopefully, at this halfway point you are feeling fine physically. You’re not yet encumbered by a large belly and probably have a reasonable amount of energy. Psychologically, you may still be very emotional, although you will no doubt have gotten used to any mood swings by now (as will your partner).

At this stage you will continue going to prenatal appointments around every four weeks. Remember, your doctor is there to monitor your health and your baby’s progress, but also to help, so do get advice on how to cope with some of the discomforts you might experience as you grow bigger.

ASK A DOCTOR

I haven’t felt my baby move yet. Should I be worried? While you understandably want to feel your baby’s movements, there is no cause for concern yet since your recent scan should have shown you that all is well with your baby.

If it’s your first baby, you may not notice the early movements since you won’t know what to expect. Also, if you’re an active person, these slight flutters may be missed. Women with a placenta lying at the front of the uterus may feel movements later, as may larger women since the movement may not be detected through the flesh.

Once you do feel movements, don’t become too focused on every one. It’s not until after 24 weeks that it becomes important to monitor the pattern. From this stage, the amount your baby